KDP Book Launch Checklist

A printable, step-by-step checklist to take your paperback from finished manuscript to a successful Amazon KDP launch. Tick each box as you go.

Book title: _____ **Launch date:** _____

1. Manuscript

- [ ] Story or content is finished, edited and proofread
- [ ] Word count recorded and page count estimated
- [ ] Front matter ready: title page, copyright page, contents
- [ ] Back matter ready: author bio, thank-you note, other books
- [ ] Content checked for copyright, permissions and trademark issues

2. Interior formatting

- [ ] Trim size chosen (for example 6 x 9 in) and used as the page size
- [ ] Margins meet KDP minimums, with larger inside margins for higher page counts
- [ ] Bleed option matches your file (only if images touch the page edge)
- [ ] Fonts are embedded and images are sharp (about 300 DPI)
- [ ] Page numbers and chapter starts are consistent
- [ ] Final page count is at least 24 and locked
- [ ] PDF checked page by page for clipped text or odd breaks

3. Cover

- [ ] Spine width calculated for the final page count and paper type
- [ ] Full-wrap size correct: back + spine + front + 0.125 in bleed on each outside edge
- [ ] Background art extends to the bleed edge
- [ ] Important text is inside the safe zone, barcode area left empty
- [ ] Cover designed at 300 DPI and exported as a single PDF without crop marks
- [ ] Spine text only if the book is thick enough (KDP suggests 80+ pages)

4. Listing details

- [ ] Title and subtitle together are within 200 characters
- [ ] Description is written for your reader, up to 4,000 characters
- [ ] All 7 keyword boxes filled, up to 50 characters each, no repeated title words
- [ ] Two relevant categories chosen
- [ ] Author name, series name and edition details checked for typos
- [ ] Age range and content settings answered honestly

5. Pricing and rights

- [ ] Printing cost checked for your page count and marketplace
- [ ] List price set above the minimum KDP allows
- [ ] Royalty and profit margin estimated, including any ad costs
- [ ] Territories and distribution options reviewed
- [ ] Ebook edition decided (royalty plan and price range checked)

6. Before you press Publish

- [ ] Reviewed the book in the KDP Previewer, every page
- [ ] Ordered a proof copy and checked print quality in your hands
- [ ] All files re-uploaded after the last edit
- [ ] Tax and payment information completed in your KDP account

7. Launch

- [ ] Book page checked after it goes live (title, cover, description)
- [ ] Launch plan written: where you will announce and when
- [ ] Email list, social posts or communities lined up
- [ ] Plan to ask early readers for honest reviews, following Amazon's rules
- [ ] Track sales, ads and royalties weekly for the first month

Useful free tools: Cover Size Calculator, Spine Width Calculator, Word Count to Pages, Royalty Calculator, Profit Margin Calculator and Listing Character Counter at toolnes.netlify.app/kdp/

Note: KDP rules, limits and prices can change. Always confirm the current requirements in your KDP account and with the official KDP help pages before you publish. This checklist is a planning aid, not a guarantee of approval.